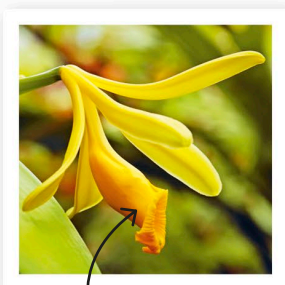


Rain forest plants

In tropical rain forests, where it is always wet and very warm, plants grow and flower all year round. Many different plants grow here, and some are very unusual, but all are specially adapted to their surroundings and could not grow in the wild anywhere else.



The vanilla orchid has yellow flowers.

Orchids can be grown as houseplants.

Amazing orchids

At least 10,000 different orchids grow in rain forests. Most get the water they need from moisture in the air, so they don't need soil to grow in. One of these, the vanilla orchid, is the source of the vanilla pods used to flavor ice cream!

Rafflesia smells so awful that it is also called the "corpse flower."

Giant parasite

Rafflesia has the largest single flower on Earth, growing to over 3 ft (1 m) across and weighing 24 lb (11 kg). This southeast Asian plant lives most of its life inside a vine, stealing food from a "host" plant, until it blooms.

